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BRAHMOS REINVIGORATING MODERN INDIA'S MILITARY MIGHT

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India's steady advancements in defence technology sphere since Independence has placed it among an elite league of nations possessing top-end, state-of-the-art military hardware. Despite long technology denial regimes the nation faced post-Independence, India has surpassed all hurdles to build a formidable military force.

Among the many powerful platforms and systems inducted in the Indian Armed Forces over the years, one weapon stands out as 'an indispensable combat asset' of modern times. BRAHMOS supersonic cruise missile system, jointly designed and developed by India and Russia, has revolutionised high-end military technology involving precision-guided weapons.

When precision guided missiles were making an impact in the battlefields in the 1990s, the emergence of BRAHMOS as world's fastest cruise missile system redefined modern warfare dynamics and strategy. Combining supersonic speed, deadly accuracy, massive firepower, stealth, and versatility, BRAHMOS established its supremacy as the 'ultimate game-changer'.

The coming together of two prominent institutions – DRDO of India and NPOM of Russia – resulted in a highly successful Joint Venture (JV) defence project. BrahMos JV elevated the 'buyer-seller' relationship between New Delhi and Moscow to 'joint partner' status and became a technology co-development, technology sharing programme.

The establishment of BrahMos Aerospace in February 1998 paved the way for the design, development and productionisation of BRAHMOS. The formidable weapon underwent its maiden successful test firing on June 12, 2001 and established its impeccable anti-ship capability. The spectacular launch placed India prominently in the global map.

The evolution of BRAHMOS continued thereafter and the JV programme brought many "firsts" for India. The powerful missile became the only weapon in its category to be inducted in all three Services of Indian Armed Forces subsequently. Owing to its cutting-edge technological superiority and highly advanced design parameters, BRAHMOS could be seamlessly integrated into the land, naval and air platforms of India.

Indian Navy deployed the deadly weapon in 2005 followed by the Indian Army in 2007, thus fortifying their capability to undertake combat operations in their respective frontiers with enormous firepower and vigour.

In 2017, BrahMos JV achieved an incredible milestone which created ripples across the world. The highly advanced BRAHMOS air-launched cruise missile (ALCM) system integrated with the frontline Sukhoi-30MKI fighter platform of Indian Air Force (IAF) underwent maiden successful launch on November 22 and validated its precision attack capability against a sea-based target.

The spectacular mission was a "first-in-the-world" feat and completed India's 'supersonic cruise missile triad'. BRAHMOS-A subsequently established its land-attack capability which bolstered the IAF's modern air combat power from stand-off ranges.

The multi-role, multi-platform BRAHMOS today has revolutionised "across-the-spectrum" warfare for joint battlefield operations.

BrahMos JV has exemplified the flagship 'Make in India' endeavours by forming the unique "BRAHMOS MIC" (missile industrial consortium). The MIC, involving a large number of public & private defence sector enterprises, institutions and laboratories of India and Russia, has been greatly contributing to the success story of BRAHMOS.

BrahMos Aerospace, in close coordination with DRDO, has also realised indigenisation of major technologies, components and systems for BRAHMOS, thus reducing the weapon's overall production, operation and maintenance costs while bolstering national security aspects.

"BRAHMOS is a weapon par excellence. Its continuous evolution in terms of technological superiority and strength has transformed it into an unparalleled system. With newer, more advanced variants presently under development, BRAHMOS is well positioned to retain its leadership into the distant future as well," says Shri Atul D Rane, Director General, BrahMos, DRDO and CEO & MD, BrahMos Aerospace.

In 2022, supersonic BRAHMOS carved its global footprint and became India's first full-scale weapon receiving a historic export order from the Republic of Philippines. Under the export contract signed on January 28, 2022, BrahMos Aerospace will deliver the shore-based BRAHMOS anti-ship weapon system to the Armed Forces of Philippines.

The BRAHMOS export breakthrough has propelled forward India's aspirations to achieve military exports worth US$5 billion by 2025.